

On the Trail

GLACIER NATIONAL PARK · GRIZZLY COUNTRY

PACK THIS

Ticked boxes we're organizing as a group.

- ☒ **Bear spray** — on a hip or chest strap, not buried in the pack
- ☐ **2–3 L water** each, plus a filter or tablets
- ☒ **Lunch and more snacks** than you think you need
- ☒ **A gallon zip** as the group trash bag
- ☒ **TP and a second zip** to carry it back out
- ☐ **Hand sanitizer**
- ☐ **Rain shell and a warm layer** — Logan Pass is cold and windy even in August
- ☐ **Sun** — hat, sunscreen, sunglasses
- ☐ **Offline map** downloaded before you lose service
- ☐ **Headlamp** on the long days
- ☒ **First aid and blister tape**

! Bears: don't surprise one

Almost every bad encounter starts with a bear that had no idea you were coming. Your job is to never be a surprise.

- **Make noise — constantly.** Talk, and keep talking. Call out at blind corners, in thick brush, near berry patches, and anywhere running water is covering the sound of you.
- **Your voice beats any gadget.** Bear bells are too quiet and sound nothing like a person. Use words, out loud, every minute or so.
- **Hike as a group of three or more, and stay together.** Larger groups are charged far less often. Nobody races ahead, nobody trails behind, nobody puts in headphones.
- **Dawn, dusk and poor visibility** are the riskiest hours — be louder then.
- **Trails close for bear activity**, and a closure is not a suggestion.
- Stay **100 yards** from any bear. That is the rule in the park, and no photo is worth closing the gap.

2 If you actually see one

- **Stop. Do not run.** Running triggers a chase, and a grizzly is faster than you over any distance.
- **Group up** and stand tall together. Pick up small children.
- **Talk to it** in a low, level voice so it reads you as human.
- **Back away slowly**, sideways, watching it. Leave it an exit — never corner a bear or come between a sow and cubs.
- **Keep your pack on.** It is body armour, and dropping it teaches a bear that people mean food.

IF IT CHARGES

- Most charges are bluffs. **Stand your ground** and get the spray out of its holster.
- **Spray at roughly 30–60 feet:** aim slightly down and lay a cloud between you and the bear. Keep spraying as it comes through.
- **Grizzly that makes contact — play dead.** Face down, legs spread, hands laced behind your neck, pack on. Stay down until you are certain it is gone.
- **Black bear, or any bear stalking you — fight back.** Hard, at the face, with anything you have.

F Food & water

- **Calorie-dense, no cooking:** nuts, jerky, hard cheese, tortillas with nut butter, dried fruit, bars.
- **Salt matters as much as sugar** on a six-to-eight hour day. Bring electrolytes, not just water.
- **2–3 L each.** Refill only through a filter or tablets — giardia is in these streams however clean the water looks.
- **Eat where you can see around you** — in the open, not in thick brush.
- **Food stays in the pack; the pack stays with you.** Not left on a rock for a photo, not at the shore for a swim.

T Trash: everything gets carried out

- **Food waste is trash too** — apple cores, orange peel, pistachio shells, crusts, crumbs from the bottom of the bag.
- **"It's natural, it'll rot" doesn't work here.** It breaks down slowly, and it teaches animals to look for food where people walk.
- One person carries **the group trash zip**.
- **Micro-trash counts:** wrapper tear-offs, tape, twist ties, fruit stickers.
- Nothing goes down a pit toilet except what a body makes.

B Bathroom, done properly

- **Go at the trailhead.** Avalanche, Logan Pass and Many Glacier all have toilets.
- **Otherwise: 200 feet** — about 70 adult paces — from water, trail and camp.
- **Dig a cathole 6–8 inches deep** in dark soil, then fill it in and scatter leaf litter over it.
- **Toilet paper and hygiene products pack out**, in a doubled opaque zip — TP doesn't break down quickly, and used products carry scent.
- **Pee on rock or gravel** — animals dig up salty soil and wreck the plants around it.
- **Take your bear spray with you and tell someone where you went.** Stepping off the trail alone and quiet is precisely the situation the noise rule exists for.